

Fujiyoshida (Chureito Pagoda & pilgrim town)

Then-and-now aerial photographs, how the ground was made, and the disasters people chose to remember — compiled automatically from public Japanese government data.



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Study area	2.6 km × 1.7 km around 35.4920° N, 138.8000° E
Oldest aerial photograph	1974–1978
Aerial series in this brief	1974–1978, 2020
Main natural landform	Alluvial fan (48%)
Former river channels	none mapped
Filled, reclaimed or drained land	1.5%
Former sea, river or pond	none mapped
Meiji-era paddies, marsh and flats	rice paddy 20%
Disaster memorials within 3 km	1 (other 1)

What this brief is. A reading aid for comparing the same ground across decades. It shows what the photographs and GSI's land surveys record; it does not describe current conditions, access or opening hours.

What it is not. Not a hazard assessment or a property survey. Landform classes describe typical tendencies of the ground; for present-day risk, read the official hazard map of the municipality.

Edition 2026-09-27. Aerial photographs, landform and Meiji-era lowland data: Geospatial Information Authority of Japan (GSI), processed by Japan Time Atlas. Memorial data: GSI Natural Disaster Memorials, summarised and translated by Japan Time Atlas.

The same ground, 1974–1978 and 2020



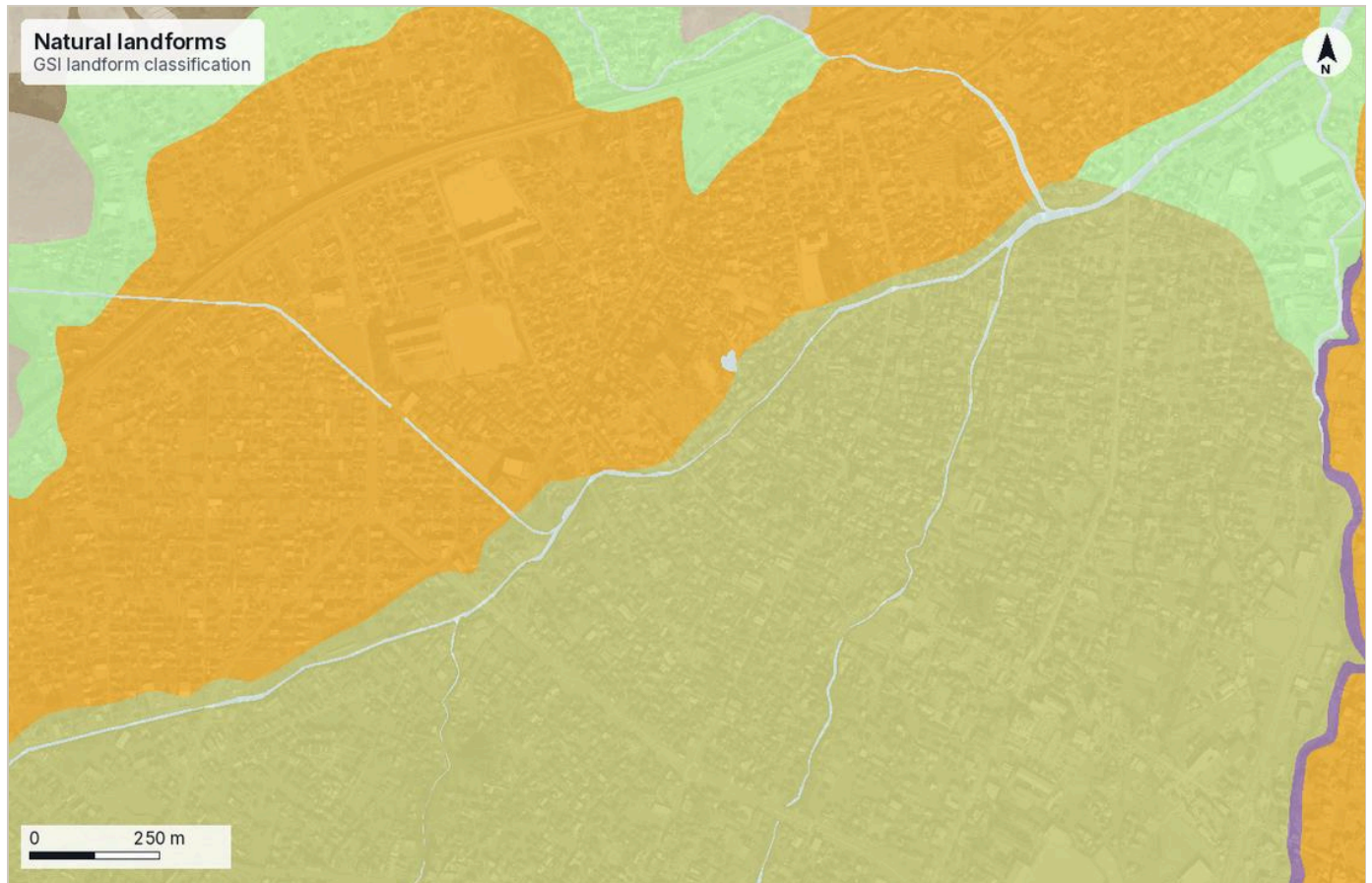
1974–1978 aerial photograph — GSI Tiles *gazo1*, cropped and annotated by Japan Time Atlas. North is up; the frame is identical in both images.



2020 annual orthophoto — GSI Tiles *nendophoto2020*, cropped and annotated by Japan Time Atlas. Capture dates within a mosaic can differ from place to place.

How to compare. Anchor on features that rarely move — river banks, rail lines, shrine and temple grounds, main roads — then look for what changed around them. Differences in tone come from film, camera and season, not from the land itself.

Rivers, shorelines and terraces



Natural landforms as classified by GSI, over a recent aerial photograph in gray. Dark blue outlines mark former river channels.

 Alluvial fan 48%	 Plateaus and terraces 38%
 Floodplain and coastal plain 10%	 Mountain and hill slopes 1.6%
 Water 1.3%	 Foothill deposits 0.8%
 Cliffs and terrace scarps 0.6%	

What the main landforms mean

Alluvial fan (48%). Gently sloping ground spreading fan-like from a valley mouth, built from sediment dropped by floods. Floodwater from the mountains, and debris flows near the valley mouth. Relatively firm ground; a slight liquefaction tendency on the lower fan.

Plateaus and terraces (38%). Flat ground standing in steps above its surroundings, left behind as the land around it was eroded. River flooding is rarely a threat unless the terrace is only slightly above the river; watch the slopes at its edges. Firm ground: shaking is relatively weak and liquefaction is unlikely.

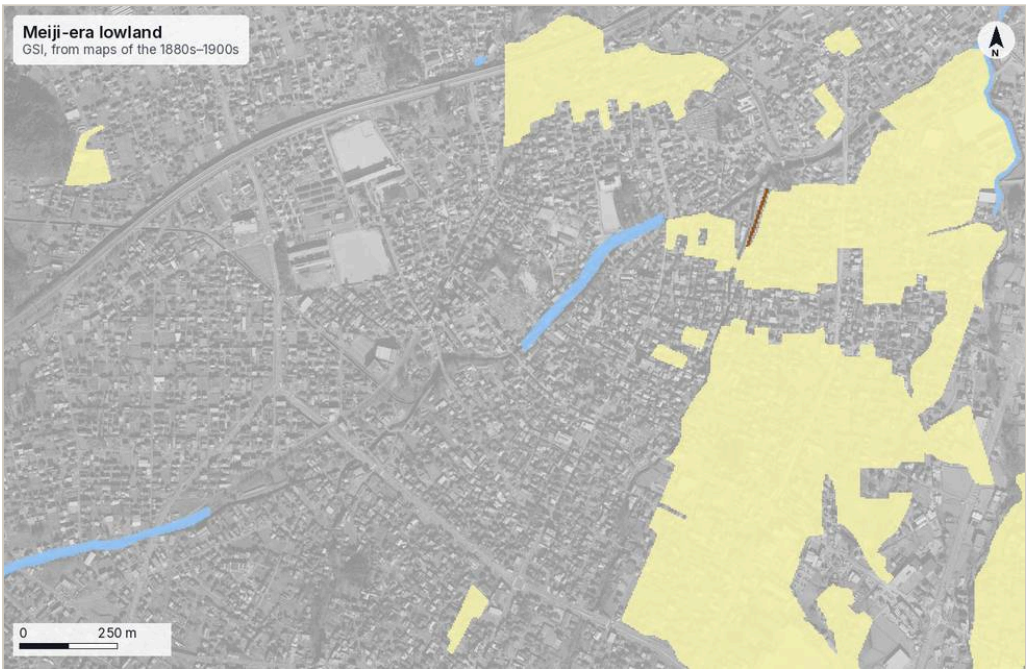
Floodplain and coastal plain (10%). Low, flat ground of little relief, built from sand and mud left by floods, or former seabed that emerged. River flooding. Ground is softer nearer the coast and shakes somewhat more; liquefaction tendency is strong on coastal plains and somewhat strong on floodplains. Storm surge near the coast.

Descriptions translated and condensed from GSI's landform-classification legend. They describe tendencies of each landform type, not the condition of any individual plot.

Fill, reclamation and the fields beneath the town



Hatching: man-made ground as classified by GSI. Teal outlines: former sea, river or pond. Dark blue outlines: former river channels.



GSI “Meiji-era lowland” data, traced from topographic maps of the 1880s-1900s; GSI warns that positions can be off by a considerable distance, especially in the Kanto and Kinki regions. Only low, wet or open ground was traced: towns, dry fields and forest of the period are left blank.

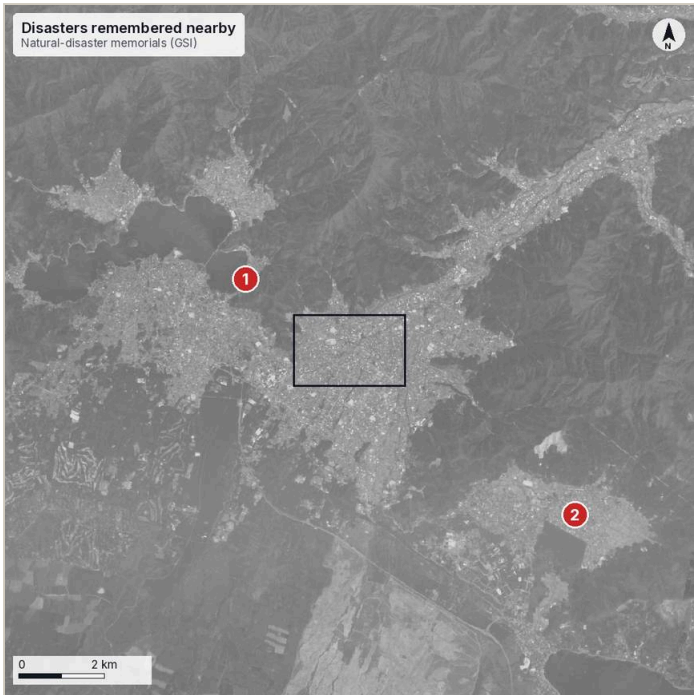
Man-made ground

-  Cut ground 1.7%
-  Filled and reclaimed land 1.5%

Meiji-era lowland

-  Rice paddy 20%
-  River, pond or sea 0.7%

Memorials to natural disasters nearby



Numbered memorials; the black rectangle is the study area of this brief. Frame 16 km across.

Fewer than three memorials stand within 3 km of the study area, so the nearest ones within 8 km are listed.

	Memorial	Disaster	Erected	Distance
1	Monument of the Lake Kawaguchi Flood Control Association 河口湖治水組合記念碑	High water on Lake Kawaguchi (Aug 1983) and the Fuji Five Lakes (9–12 Sep 1991) · other	2002	2.9 km
2	Memorial to the 1923 Great Kanto Earthquake and the floods that followed 大震水災記念碑	Great Kanto Earthquake (1 Sep 1923) and the heavy rain that followed (14 Sep 1923) · flood / landslide or debris flow / earthquake	1924	6.5 km

What the memorials record

- 1. Monument of the Lake Kawaguchi Flood Control Association.** Lake Kawaguchi has no outflowing river, so rising water has long threatened lakeside life. After heavy rain from Typhoon No. 5 in August 1983 the lake kept rising for about a week, flooding hotels and homes near the shore (68 houses above floor level). In September 1991 heavy rain raised the Fuji Five Lakes, submerging lakeside roads and flooding 13 houses.
- 2. Memorial to the 1923 Great Kanto Earthquake and the floods that followed.** The earthquake of 1 September 1923 brought down 72 shrines, temples and houses in Uchino, cracked roads and fields and sent muddy water gushing up; aftershocks were frequent. Heavy rain from the night of 13 September then caused landslides and floods that left trees and stones piled about 2 m deep, ruined the fields and flooded 291 houses.

Source: GSI Natural Disaster Memorials (自然災害伝承碑). English names and notes are Japan Time Atlas translations and summaries of GSI's Japanese descriptions; the memorials' own inscriptions may say more. "Erected" is the year GSI records for the monument.

Where every element comes from

- **Aerial photographs** (pp. 2) — Geospatial Information Authority of Japan (GSI), GSI Tiles: series *gazo1* (1974–1978) and *nendophoto2020*. Cropped, resized and annotated by Japan Time Atlas. List of GSI Tiles: <https://maps.gsi.go.jp/development/ichiran.html>
- **Landform classification** (pp. 3–4) — GSI landform-classification vector tiles (natural and artificial landforms), compiled by GSI from its Land Condition Maps, Flood Control Terrain Classification Maps and vulnerable-landform surveys. Rendered, measured and translated into English by Japan Time Atlas. https://github.com/gsi-cyberjapan/experimental_landformclassification
- **Meiji-era lowland** (p. 4) — GSI “明治期の低湿地” tiles and legend (https://maps.gsi.go.jp/legend/lw_legend.pdf), measured and translated by Japan Time Atlas.
- **Natural disaster memorials** (p. 5) — GSI Natural Disaster Memorials (自然災害伝承碑), registered by municipalities, <https://www.gsi.go.jp/bousaichiri/denshouhi.html>; processed by Japan Time Atlas (selection by distance, English translation and summary). Memorial photographs are not reproduced.
- GSI content is used under the GSI Content Terms of Use, which follow the Public Data License v1.0 (PDL1.0, compatible with CC BY 4.0). Data retrieved 2026-09-27.
- **Outline of Japan** — Data of Japan / JapanPrefGeoJson (public domain), simplified.

Method

The study area is a fixed rectangle of 2.6 × 1.7 km. Every GSI photo series that covers at least 85% of it is included; the newest annual orthophoto covering at least 90% of it is used as “now”, with any gap filled from GSI's latest seamless mosaic. Landform shares are areas of the rectangle measured on GSI's polygons at zoom level 14, each class merged before measuring. Meiji-era shares count map pixels by legend color. Memorials are selected by straight-line distance from the center of the study area.

Limits

Historical series are mosaics of photographs taken on different dates; GSI publishes the flight date of each photograph. Landform data record conditions at the time of survey. Nothing in this brief shows present-day access, safety or opening hours.

Area Dossier. The same district with a 4–8 page English history, written from Japanese library sources and cited page by page.

Deep Research. A single hamlet or address, researched in libraries and archives.

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